Contrarian climate claims in U.S. congressional speech

110,238 climate-related speeches, 1994–2024, classified by the fine-tuned cards-latest model. Super-claim 0 (“no claim”) excluded from contrarian cuts.

PART I — CORPUS & CLAIM DESCRIPTION

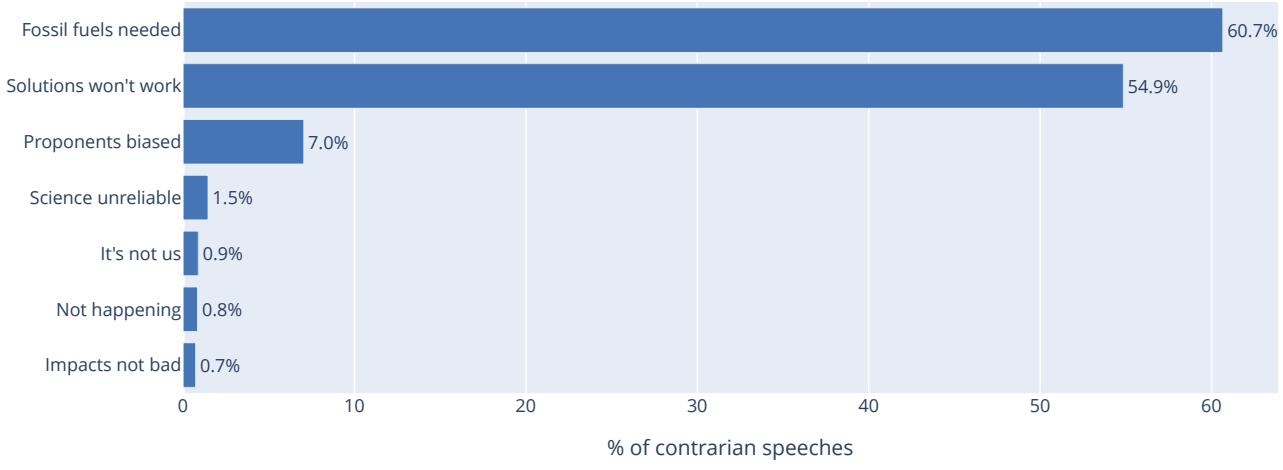
1. Corpus overview

All speeches pre-filtered to climate-related.

METRIC	VALUE
Speeches (climate-related)	110,238
Unique speakers	1,642
Date range	1994–2024
Congresses	17
Party split	Dem 55,438 / Rep 49,548
Chamber	House 67,096 / Senate 37,792
Speeches w/ ≥1 contrarian claim	13,661 (12.4%)
Contrarian claims per contrarian speech (mean)	2.43

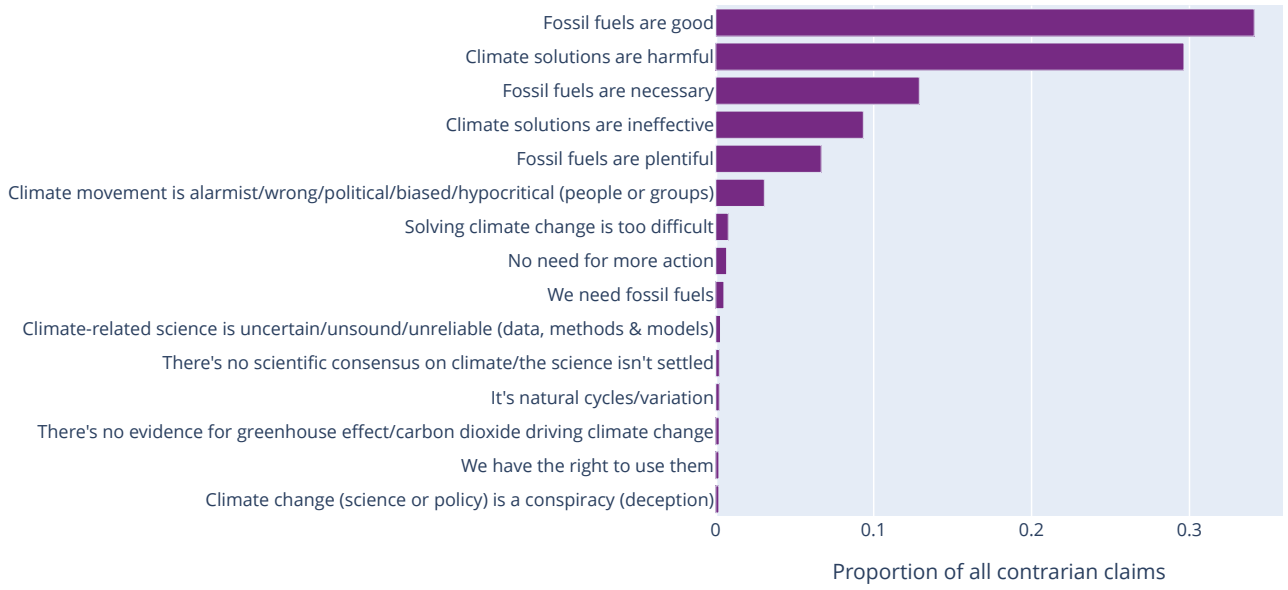
2. Super-claim prevalence

Among 13,661 contrarian speeches (multi-label).



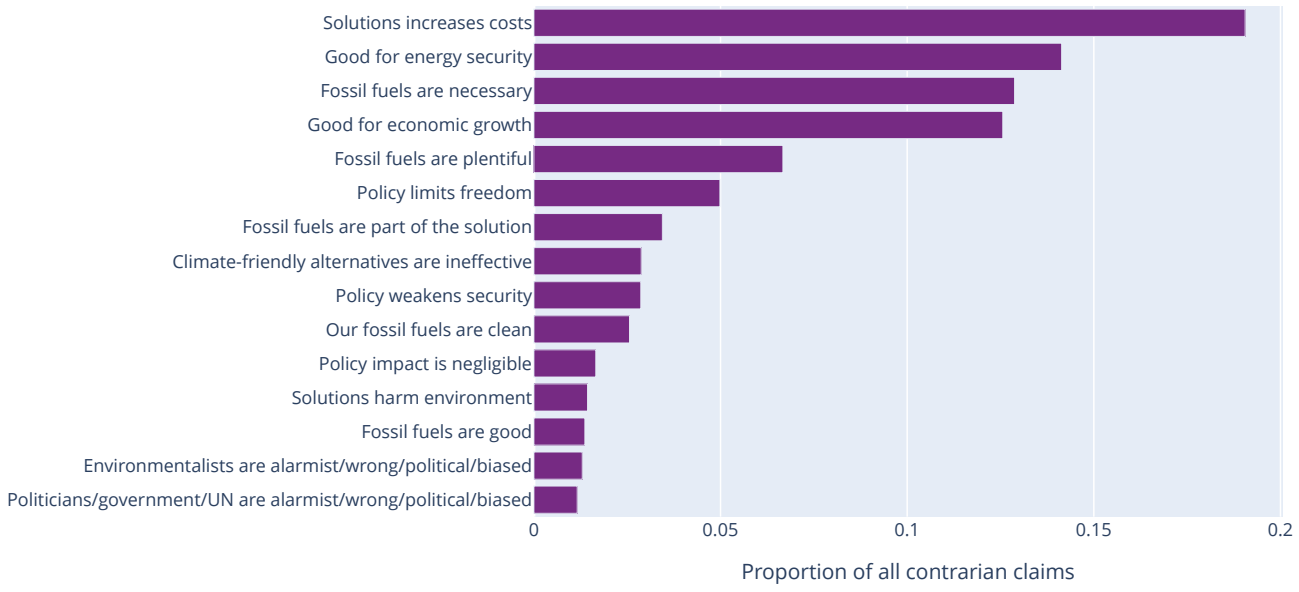
3. Top-15 Level 2 claims

Share of 33,175 contrarian claim mentions.



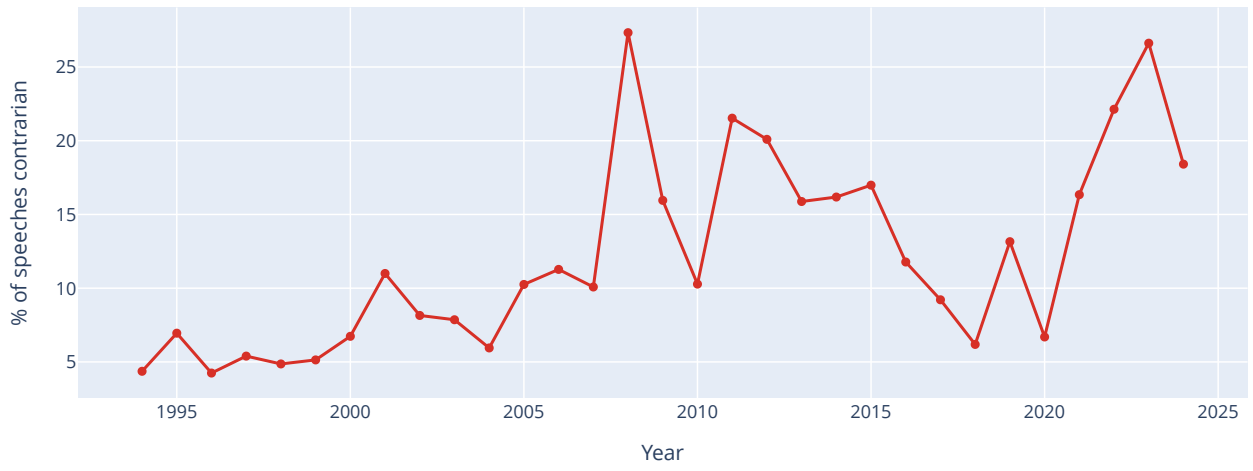
4. Top-15 Level 3 claims

Share of 33,175 contrarian claim mentions.



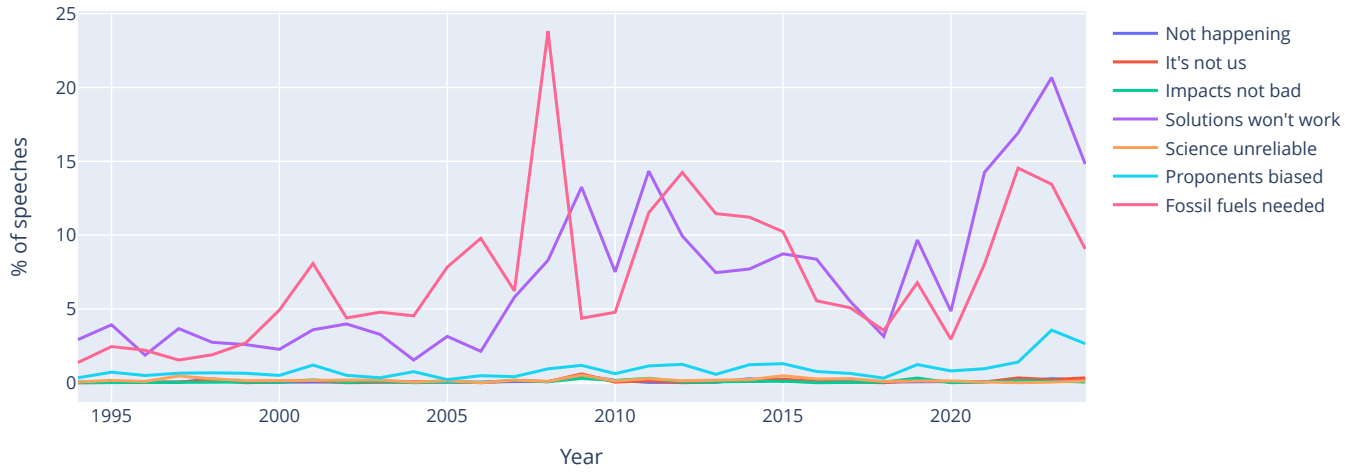
5. Contrarian discourse over time

Speeches making any contrarian claim, by year.



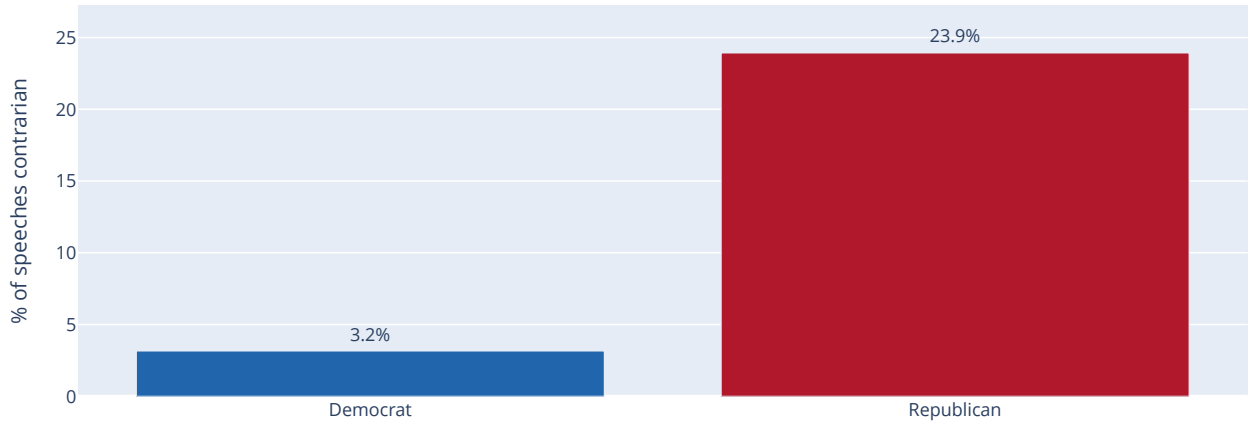
6. Each super-claim over time

Proportion of speeches per year, by super-claim.



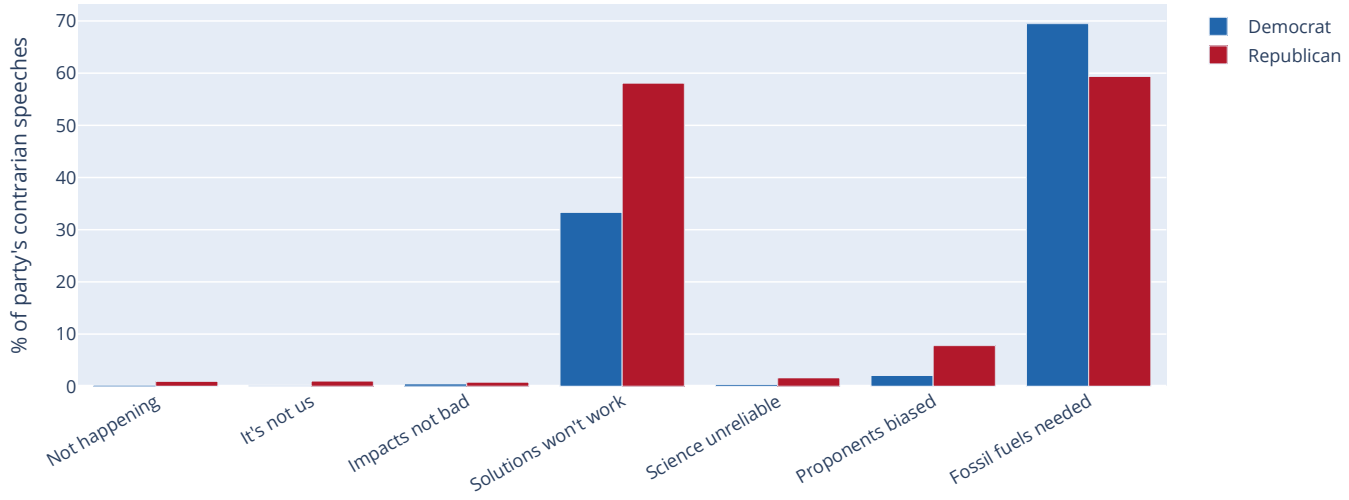
7. Contrarian rate by party

Share of each party's speeches that are contrarian.

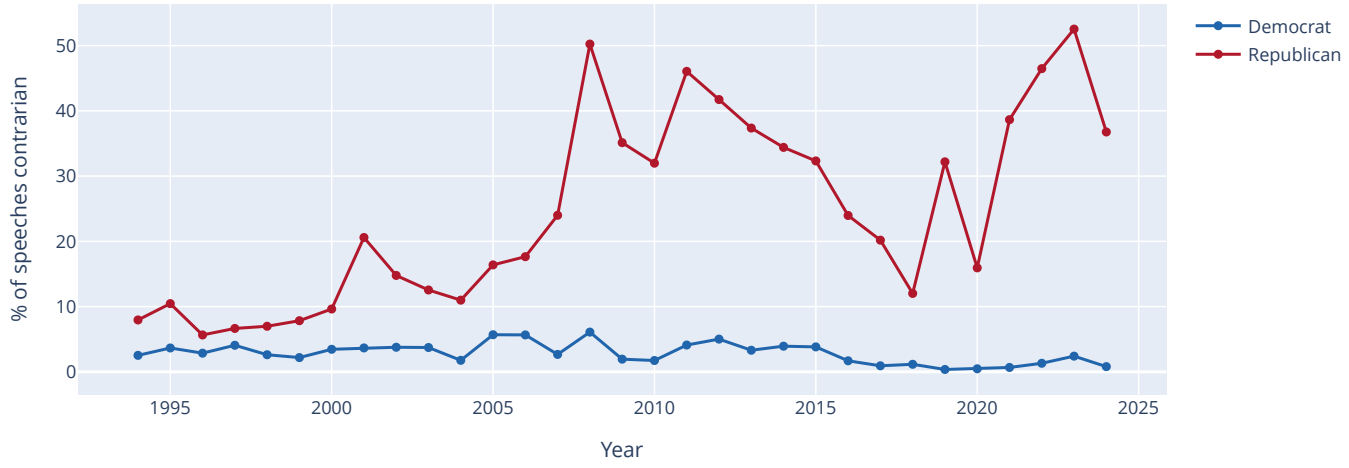


8. Super-claim mix by party

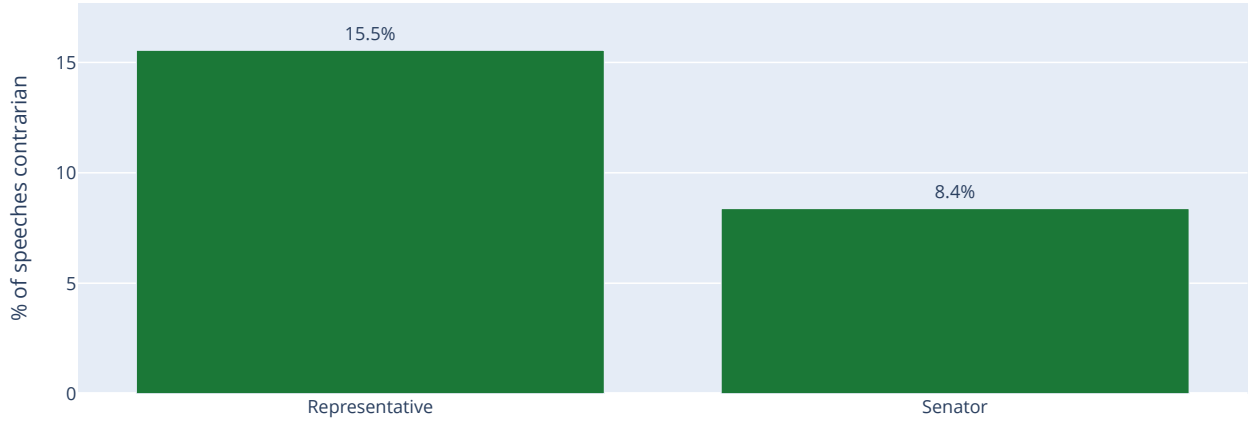
Within each party's contrarian speeches.



9. Contrarian rate by party over time

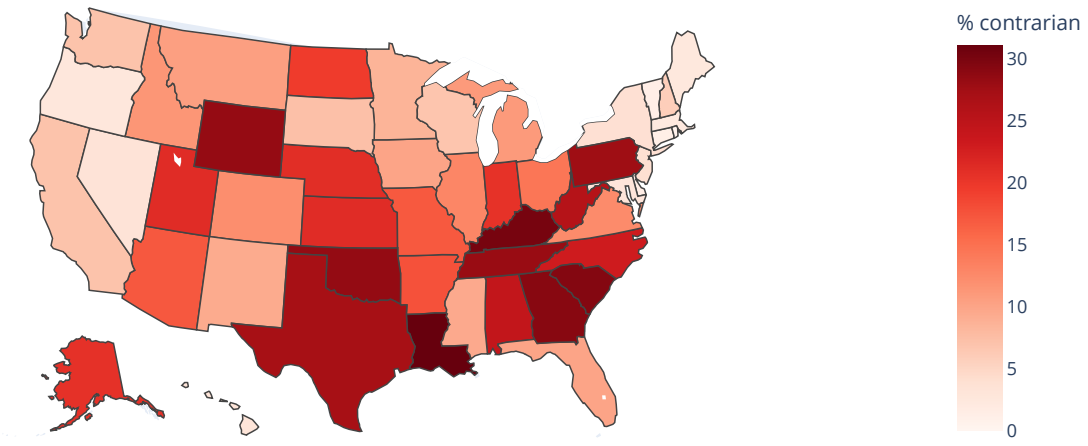


10. Contrarian rate by chamber



11. Contrarian rate by state

Share of each state's climate speeches that are contrarian.

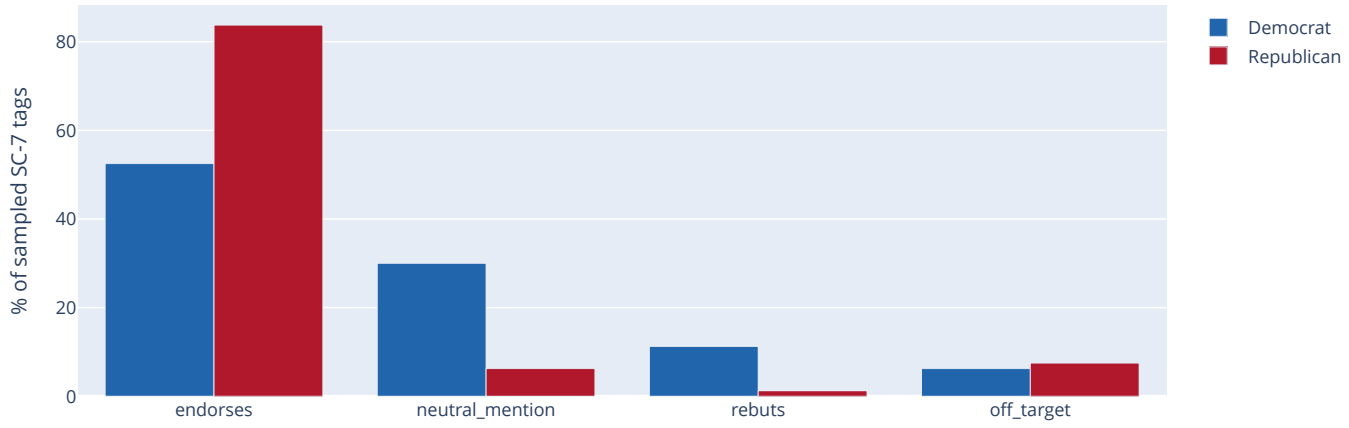


PART II — VALIDITY & ROBUSTNESS

12. SC-7 precision audit (independent Claude judge)

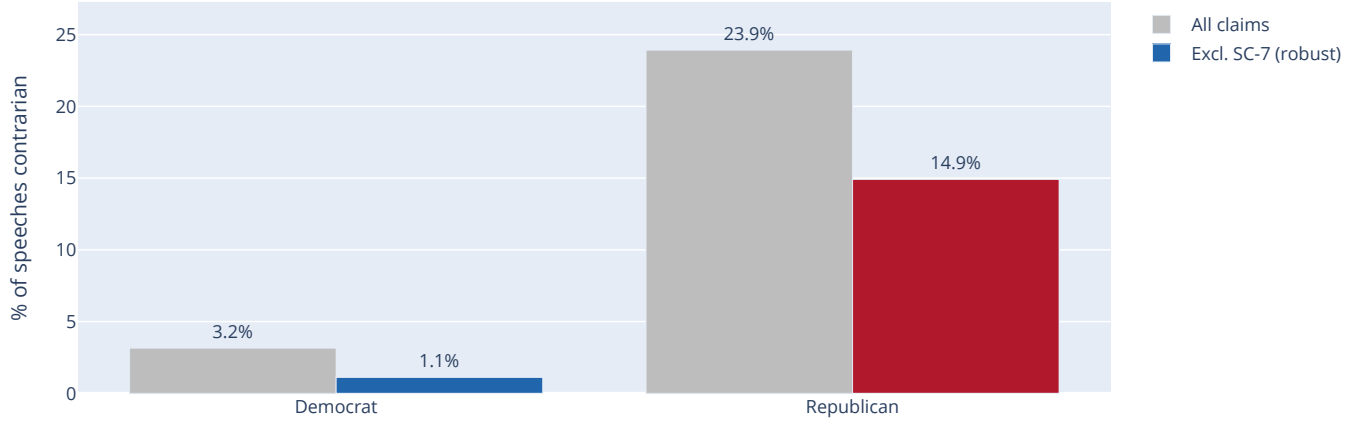
Republican SC-7 is reliable (85%); Democratic SC-7 is only ~52% genuine — mostly neutral mentions and rebuttals. Treat Democratic 'Fossil fuels needed' with caution.

PARTY	N	TRUE POS.	PRECISION
Democrat	80	42	**52%**
Republican	79	67	**85%**



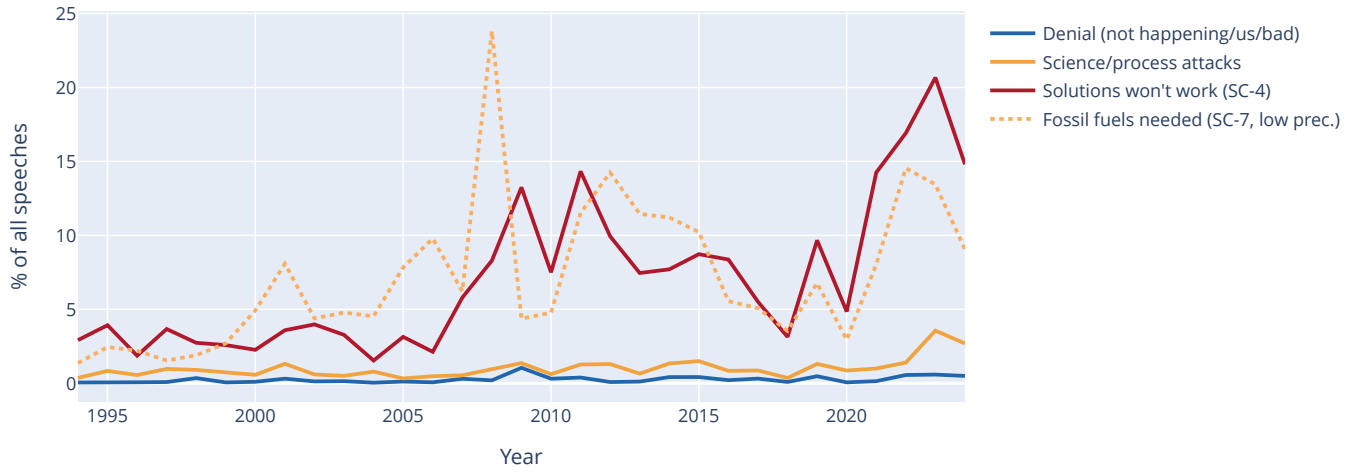
13. Partisan gap is robust to the SC-7 problem

Dropping low-precision SC-7 *widens* the gap to 13× (from 8×).



14. Denial vs. delay over time

Lamb et al. (2020) framing. Hard denial stays marginal; 'delay' dominates — and the rise holds on the reliable SC-4, independent of the noisier SC-7 (dotted).



15. Fossil-money gradient, within party (robust)

Contrarian rate by within-party fossil-money quintile, excluding low-precision SC-7. Holds for Republicans (9.5%→18.6%); weak but positive for Democrats. Descriptive, not causal.

